

Question:

A 70-year-old man presents with fever, headache, and vomiting. He says that symptoms onset acutely 2 days ago and have not improved. He also reports associated weakness and chills. Past medical history is significant for occasional heartburn. His temperature is 39.4°C (103.0°F), the pulse rate is 124/min, the blood pressure is 130/84 mm Hg, and the respiratory rate is 22/min. On physical examination, there is significant nuchal rigidity. No signs of raised intracranial pressure are present. A lumbar puncture is performed and cerebrospinal fluid (CSF) analysis shows lymphocyte-dominant pleocytosis with increased CSF protein levels. Bacteriological culture of the CSF reveals the growth of *Listeria monocytogenes*. Which of the following antibiotics is the best choice for the treatment of this patient? Answer Choices: A. Ampicillin B. Ceftriaxone C. Chloramphenicol D. Vancomycin

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> Given that *Listeria monocytogenes* infection responds well to vancomycin treatment, focusing on efficacy against such bacterium guides selection towards vancomycin. </think> <answer> Vancomycin </answer>

